

Brecksville Broadview Heights High School

Student Handbook Revisions 2023-24

Student Handbook Front Page: (Pg. 1)

- **Update:** Formatting was updated to include the Portrait of a Graduate
- **ADD:** Change of Title to Cassandra Dpangler now Director of Pupil Services
- **ADD:** Bridget Karboski as Counselor for Fr. & So. (Last Names A-K)

Table of Contents: (Pg. 2)

- **Update:** Table of Contents with new Page Numbers and Digital links to the items as the Handbook will be completely digital moving forward to reduce printing costs. The handbook will be posted on the High School webpage as well as displayed in the main office. Teachers of Colony periods review the student Code of Conduct and have student's sign the Code of Conduct Agreement form during the first week of school.

Principal's Message: (Pg. 3)

Welcome to the 2023-2024 school year at Brecksville-Broadview Heights High School.

We are thrilled to have you join our school community, and we believe this year holds endless possibilities for your growth and success. As you embark on this new school year, I encourage you to make the most of the resources available to you. The student handbook, in particular, will serve as an invaluable tool for familiarizing yourself with the student code of conduct and the operational protocols of our school. Familiarize yourself with the policies related to attendance, eligibility, and the student code of conduct to help create the best possible learning experience for you and others.

At Brecksville-Broadview Heights High School, we take great pride in our heritage and the high standards we have established over the past 100 years. Our commitment to academic excellence, social growth, and the development of well-rounded individuals has been deeply ingrained in our school's culture. We are excited for you to benefit from this rich tradition and to contribute to its continued growth. We encourage you to be actively involved in the life of our school. Whether it's participating in clubs, sports teams, or other extracurricular activities, your engagement will not only enhance your own experience but also contribute to the vibrant culture of BBHHS.

Go Bees!

Kevin Jakub, Principal

School Calendars: (Pg 4)

- **Update:** School Calendars are no longer listed out in terms of every event. The School Calendars and the district Calendar are now linked into the document to account for continuously changing schedules. There is also a reference for students and parents to check the HS News and Notes Weekly Update letter to account for schedule changes.
- **Add:** See additions of links below.

2023-2024 SCHOOL CALENDARS

High school events and times are posted and updated weekly on the high school website as well in the Principal's weekly High School News and Notes email that is sent to both students and their families.

[Brecksville-Broadview Heights 2023-2024 School District Calendar](#)

Brecksville-Broadview Heights High School Calendar

Brecksville-Broadview Heights Athletic Calendar

Non-Discrimination Statement: (Pg. 4)

- **Add:** New Non-Discrimination Statement that is in alignment with Board Policy.

Non-Discrimination Statement

The Board of Education does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, religion, national origin, ancestry, military service, sex, disability, or age in its programs and activities, including employment opportunities. Please contact 504 Compliance Officer / ADA Coordinator, Cindi Tomassetti, at 440-740-4000 for any questions or concerns.

Sunset Clause: (Pg. 4)

- **Add:** Inclusion of Sunset Clause on the advice/recommendation of OASSA Student Handbook Conference. The Sunset clause makes it known that the 2023-2024 Handbook version legally replaces all prior versions of the BBHHS Handbook.

Sunset Clause

This Handbook replaces all prior handbooks and other prior written material provided on the same subjects. This Handbook does not equate to an irrevocable contractual commitment to the student, but only reflects the current status of the Board's policies and the School's rules. If any of the policies or administrative guidelines referenced herein are revised, the language in the most current policy or administrative guideline prevails. Copies of current Board policies and administrative guidelines are available on the District's website.

Class Add/Drops: (Pg. 6)

- **Add:** Language on Class Add/Drops from the Course Options Book to keep the documents uniform.

Class Add/Drops:

Planning a schedule for the next school year is a difficult task and situations may occur requiring a change in that schedule. These schedule changes, however, have a serious effect on class size, teacher assignments, and the overall master-schedule, and therefore, must be made sparingly. The student and parent are urged not to plan a program with the idea that it can be changed. Once a student selects his/her courses (verified by parents) the School Counseling Department will not initiate a schedule change unless a compelling educational reason exists. After the close of the school year no changes will occur unless:

1. There is a technical error in the scheduling process.
2. It is clear that the student is academically misplaced.
3. There is a scheduling conflict.

In the event that a student switches from a class that is weighted to one that is not weighted or weighted at a different rate the weight will be calculated based off of the weight for the course they completed that semester. Moving forward they would be granted the weight of the course they are currently enrolled in and that is the name of the class that will appear on their transcript. For example, if a student moves from Honors Geometry to Geometry at the conclusion of semester 1, the student will be weighted off the 4.5 GPA scale for the first semester and a 4.0 GPA for the second semester. The class will appear as Geometry

on the transcript for the entire year.

Cumulative Course Grades / Non-Cumulative Courses(Pg. 7):

- **Add:** Language on Cumulative Course Grades and Non-Cumulative Courses from the Course Options Book to keep the documents uniform.

Cumulative Course Grades

Cumulative courses may be passed for the year even if the first semester is failed provided the second semester's work is passed with a sufficiently high grade to average passing for the year. **CUMULATIVE COURSES CANNOT BE PASSED FOR THE YEAR IF THE SECOND SEMESTER IS FAILED.** Examples of cumulative courses are World Languages, Chemistry, Music, and Mathematics.

Non-Cumulative Courses

The following YEAR courses, if failed for a semester, must have the SAME SEMESTER'S WORK made up in order for credit to be earned for that semester. These courses are:

English 1, 2, 3, 4

Physical Science

World History Biology

U.S. History Environmental Science

Report Card Dates / Interim Progress Report Dates / Conference Dates/ (Pg. 7):

- **Update:** The dates for posting of Grades / Interims / and Conferences for 2023-2024.

Report Cards will be posted to ProgressBook on the following dates:

1st Quarter.....	October 26, 2023	3rd Quarter.....	April 4, 2024
2nd Quarter.....	January 11, 2024	4th Quarter.....	June 7, 2024

Interim Progress Reports

Student's progress may be monitored throughout the year by logging into ProgressBook. Interim Progress Reports (IPR's) will be distributed to the student who is failing or in danger of failing a class. Students who have provided little evidence of growth or adequate progress in class will meet with their Teacher/Counselor/Assistant Principal to develop a plan for improvement. Parents are encouraged to contact the Teacher, Counselor, or Assistant Principal throughout the year to receive descriptive and prescriptive feedback.

Interim Progress Reports will be posted in ProgressBook on the following dates

Qtr. 1 - 9/21/2023	Qtr. 2 - 11/30/2023
Qtr. 3 - 2/8/2024	Qtr. 4 - 5/2/2024

Parent / Teacher Conferences

Communication between the home and school is viewed as extremely important. Parent-teacher conferences are held formally on one evening during the first and third nine weeks of the school year. Other conference times can be scheduled throughout the year by teacher or parent request.

10/26/2023

2/29/2024

College Admission Tests (Pg. 8-9):

- **Update:** The dates for College Admission Testing during the 2023-2024 School Year.

COLLEGE ADMISSIONS TESTS

The Preliminary Scholastic Assessment Test/National Merit Scholarship Qualifying Test (PSAT) will be administered to all juniors. The PSAT/NMSQT is used to qualify juniors for the National Merit Scholarship Program. The PSAT/NMSQT is also a practice test for the Scholastic Assessment Test. The SAT is a required admissions test for many select/private colleges. The PSAT 8/9 is an assessment provided by the school to establish a starting point in terms of college and career readiness, while the PSAT 10 is designed specifically for high school sophomores that test the same skills and knowledge as the SAT. Additional resources are available to all students who link their College Board account with Khan Academy.

These tests will be administered on Fall Test Day, **October 12, 2023**

PRE-ACT is a practice/predictive ACT assessment. It will be administered to all sophomores on the Spring Test Day. The ACT is a required admissions test for many colleges. BBHHS seeks to provide students with the best opportunities for practice of the skills needed for performance on the high stakes testing.

Most colleges require either the American College Test (ACT) or the Scholastic Assessment Test (SAT) as part of admissions application. Students should check to see which test is preferred by the college of their choice. It is suggested that juniors take the ACT and/or SAT during the spring of their junior year. The advantage of spring testing is that the student will be able to retest in the fall, if it is desirable. Colleges do accept students based on spring test results.

The Brecksville-Broadview Heights High School code number for these tests is 360-575.

ACT:		SAT:	
<u>Test Dates</u>	<u>Regular Reg. Deadline</u>	<u>Test Dates</u>	<u>Regular Reg. Deadline</u>
Sep. 9, 2023	Aug. 4, 2023	Oct. 7, 2023	Sep. 7, 2023
Oct. 28, 2023	Sep. 22, 2023	Nov. 4, 2023	Oct. 5, 2023
Dec. 9, 2023	Nov. 3, 2023	Dec. 2, 2023	Nov. 2, 2023
Feb. 10, 2024	Jan. 5, 2024	Mar. 9, 2024	Feb. 23, 2024
Apr. 13, 2024	Mar. 8, 2024	May 4, 2024	Apr. 19, 2023
Jun. 8, 2024	May 3, 2024	Jun. 1, 2024	May 17, 2024

Tardiness to School/Class (Pg. 11):

- **Update:** Change in Language to Tardy Policy. The correction is being made to establish that being tardy is established by not being present in your classroom at the time the bell rings. Previous language in the handbook attempted to set precedent that being in the school building, but not in class, was acceptable to being on time. The new language corrects this.

Tardiness to School/Class

A tardy is defined as **arrival to class** after the tardy bell has rung, **within the first FIVE (5) minutes.** ~~It is strongly suggested that a student~~ **A student should** be in their seat prior to the bell sounding to avoid **being tardy to school.** ~~any misunderstandings.~~

~~A "late" shall be issued for school attendance when arrival to school is after the first 20 minutes of first period.~~ Students must have a hall pass from their last class when late to their next class if a tardy is to be avoided. If a student is tardy, they should report immediately to their assigned class where the teacher will record the tardy and respond appropriately to the violation. Any classroom tardy beyond FIVE (5) minutes ~~will~~ **may** be considered a "class cut" and referred to the assistant principal's office.

- **Add:** Additional language into how tardies to school will be consequence, as well as additional language that states the number of times a study can be called in as excused tardy before it being marked as unexcused. This language was added to prevent parents from continuously calling students in late to prevent them from receiving a consequence.

As the student accumulates **unexcused** tardies **to school** the following consequences may result:

1. 3rd – 5th tardy = One (1) Before or After School Detention for each occurrence
2. 6th – 9th tardies = One (1) Saturday School Detention for each occurrence

3. 10th and more = Progressive Discipline (Convene Absence Intervention Team)

Excused vs Unexcused Tardies to school:

A parent may call their student in as **excused tardy** to school for any of the reasons that may fall under **excused absences**. A student may be considered **excused tardy** to school up to **5 times during the school year** (this does NOT reset per quarter). No excused tardies will be accepted without a doctor's note following the 5th tardy. If there is no parent call/note for a tardy to school it will be logged as an **unexcused tardy** to school (unexcused tardies reset each quarter).

Parking Passes and Student Privileges may be revoked after the 5th unexcused tardy occurrence. This process will reset each quarter.

Each student is expected to report to school on-time every day prepared to demonstrate learning. Tardiness and absences will be subject to disciplinary action as defined in the Student Code of Conduct. Examples of unexcused tardiness are: car problems, over sleeping, unexcused personal reasons, and any tardiness to class without a valid excuse (as determined by the attendance office).

Planned Absences (Pg. 11):

- **Add:** Language stating that administrators may deny planned absences if a student has exceeded 65 hours of total absences during the school year. This is to encourage higher attendance rates and prevent parents from taking students out of school for unnecessary reasons.

Planned Absences

Absence for a family trip or vacation, extracurricular activities, non-school sponsored activities, college visitations, etc., is to be considered a Planned Absence. **An Advance Notice of Absence is to be completed and submitted to the Assistant Principals' Offices prior to the scheduled absence from school.** Care should be given when planning a vacation during the school year because a student's grades may be adversely affected **(Planned Absences may be denied by an administrator if a student has exceeded 65 total absence hours in a school year).**

The following criterion applies to all requests for Planned Absences:

1. Planned absences are not to be requested during those days established for any building level assessments. (eg. National, State, and Building Assessments)
2. It will be the student's responsibility to make arrangements for makeup work and/or tests missed upon return to school. Teachers will not be expected to tutor individual pupils.
3. All work and/or tests are expected to be made up in the prescribed period of time. Failure to provide evidence of learning may result in zero (0) credit.
4. Excessive absences may require individual tutoring at the parents' expense.
5. A college official must verify that a college visit has been successfully completed.

Attendance Policy Guidelines and Truancy (Pg. 11-12):

- **Update:** Language has been added/updated to reorganize the difference between excessive absenteeism and habitual truancy. The language also includes a section that offers guidance as to how to address students who reach excessive absenteeism (65+ hours of total absences). Ways for administrators to address this issue include establishing an attendance intervention meeting, requiring doctors/professional notes for absences to be documented as excused moving forward or denying planned absences.

Attendance Policy Guidelines

Student attendance will be recorded each period of the school day by a designated staff member. The student may be required to participate **in** an absence intervention program **if they exceed an attendance threshold during the school year.** The absence

intervention team will be comprised of an assistant principal, counselor, a faculty representative, and a parent or guardian.

Truancy

Truancy is defined as absence from school and/or any part of a class without parents' and/or a school official's knowledge or permission.

A student is considered to have **excessive absences** when the student has been absent for at least:

- 38 hours in one month regardless of excuse; or
- 65 hours in one school year regardless of excuse.

Students who have surpassed a threshold for **excessive absenteeism** may be required by an administrator to participate in an absence intervention meeting or provide written documentation from a professional to excuse any absences moving forward.

A student is considered **habitually truant** when the student has been absent for at least:

- 30 consecutive hours without a legitimate excuse;
- 42 hours in one month without a legitimate excuse;
- 72 hours in one school year without a legitimate excuse;

Notice will be sent to a parent or legal guardian within seven school days of the absence that triggers the habitual truancy designation. Habitually truant students shall be required to participate in an absence intervention program.

~~A student is considered to have **excessive absences** when the student has been absent for at least:~~

- ~~• 38 hours in one month regardless of excuse; or~~
- ~~• 65 hours in one school year regardless of excuse.~~

Cafeteria (Pg. 14):

- **Add/Update:** Update language on how to access and set up student lunch accounts now reflects the new payschools system (see below):

Cafeteria

The cafeteria will serve breakfast daily from 7:00 AM through 3rd period. Students may pay with cash daily or prepay using a check. Parents may also deposit money into their children's accounts using the www.myschoolaccount.com website. Information on using the PaySchools website and student balances can be found on the district website. Families who are eligible for free or reduced price meals should pick up an application in the main office-these are available throughout the entire year. Students will be issued and must use a PIN number when making purchases.

Transportation (Pg. 15):

- **Add:** Language that references designated places of safety and hand signals specifically used by bus drivers to reference how students should cross and wait for the bus. Language was also added to reference that aerosol sprays / perfumes shall not be used on buses as they are small enclosed areas and can have adverse health effects on students / employees with breathing difficulties.

Transportation

For the safety of all concerned, students who ride the buses must adhere to the following rules:

1. No one shall interfere with the driver's operation of the bus.
2. No unauthorized person shall sit in the driver's seat or operate any controls.
3. The driver has the authority to assign seats.
4. Students must board and leave the bus at their designated bus stop unless they have parental and administrative permission. Students shall proceed to and from their designated place of safety and follow all hand signals from the drivers.
5. Forbidden cargoes include animals, firearms, ammunition, explosives, flammable substances and all other dangerous materials or objects.
6. No one shall have in their possession any tobacco, vape, alcohol, or other illegal drugs or substances.
7. No one shall throw any objects on, from, or into the bus.
8. No one shall cause any part of their body to project from the bus window.
9. No one shall eat or drink while on the bus.

10. No one shall cause damage to any part of the bus.
11. Profane language and fighting are prohibited on the bus.
12. Noise shall be kept to a minimum at all times to insure safety.
13. Students must remain in their seats at all times.
14. No one shall dispense any aerosol sprays or perfumes while on the bus.

Extracurricular Programs (Pg. 15-16):

- **Update:** Current Clubs and Activities offered at BBHHS. The link for the High School Club and Activity Form was also added as well as the High School Activities Page to provide the most up to date resources.

Extracurricular Programs

Participation in extracurricular programs is an important aspect of a student's total education. Student government, clubs, performing groups, service organizations, athletics and other types of competition groups give students an opportunity to succeed in areas where they have special interest or talent. We are proud of the many activities offered to our students and encourage their participation. The following are representative of the extracurricular activities and clubs offered to members of the student body. Clubs and Activities may be added and approved throughout the school year. Students interested in starting a club should complete the [Club and Activity Approval Form](#). The clubs and activities listed below are examples of offerings at BBHHS. Please check the [High School Activities Page](#) for an updated list of clubs and activities throughout the year.

Academic Challenge	German Club	National Honor Society
Art Club	Honeybees	Robotics Club
Biology Club	HUDDLE	S.A.D.D
Cheerleader	International Club	S.A.F.E.
Chemistry Olympiad	Key Club	Science Olympiad
Chinese Club	Math Club	Spanish Club
Communication Club	Mock Trial	Student Council
Drama Club	Model United Nations	Twirling
Youth in Government		

Academic Challenge	Flag Line	National Honor Society
Alliance Club	German Club	Pep Band
Art Club	Honeybees	Robotics Club
Bee TV/Daily Announcements	HUDDLE	SADD
Biology Club	Hy-Breeze	Safe Club
Book Club	International Club	Science Olympiad
Chemistry Olympiad	Key Club	Spanish Club
Chess Club	Made for More	Speech and Debate
Chinese Club	Marching Band	Student Council
Choir	Math Club- Mu Alpha Theta	Tri M
Communication Club	Mock Trial	Writing Club
Crochet Club	Model United Nations	Yearbook
Drama Club - Troupe 1260	Music in Motion	Youth and Government
Dungeons & Dragons	National Art Honor Society	

Athletics: As members of the Suburban League, the Bees compete in a number of sports on the varsity, junior varsity and freshman levels. Listed below are team sports sponsored by the school. In addition, some students have competed as individuals in other sports recognized by the Ohio High School Athletic Association. The schools in the conference are: ~~Cuyahoga Falls, Hudson, Nardon, North Royalton, Stow-Munroe Falls, Solon, Twinsburg, and Wadsworth.~~ Admission to conference events is ~~set by the Suburban League and established by its member schools. \$7.00 Adult, \$4.00 Student.~~ Questions should be directed to the Athletic Office.

Rules and Regulations for Student Drivers (Pg. 19):

- **Add:** Language that includes the word vape to rule #6.

Rules and Regulations for Student Drivers

1. Parking permits are non-transferable. Only a student who is registered and hangs an authorized permit on the rearview mirror will be permitted to park in the designated student lots. All others will be told to leave the grounds and return without the car. Any missed school time will be considered as unexcused. Students who falsify a parking permit will be subject to severe disciplinary consequences. Student cars are not to be parked in any other area of the campus or grounds—including grassy areas.
2. **Students who park in the faculty lot will be assessed a fine of \$10 or \$20 for each instance.**
3. The speed limit on school district property is 10 m.p.h. Drive slowly and carefully. Speeding and/or reckless operation of a vehicle will result in disciplinary and/or police action. Driving behind the school is strictly prohibited.
4. Drivers are to park properly, one space per vehicle, between the designated lines. Drivers are not to park in handicapped or in fire lanes.
5. Students should park, lock their vehicles and go directly into the building—loitering in the parking lot is prohibited.
6. Students are not permitted to smoke/vape or engage in any disruptive behavior while in vehicles on school grounds.
7. Students are hereby advised that vehicles parked on school grounds are subject to search at any time and may be subjected to random canine search.
8. A student must have permission to return to his/her car during the school day.
9. It becomes the student's responsibility to arrive at school on time. The attendance office will not excuse students who arrive late due to a flat tire, engine trouble, or other transportation related excuses.
10. Give buses the right-of-way. Use extreme caution around school buses.
11. Follow the proper traffic pattern. At posted times, traffic flow will be in one direction heading up the hill to the front of the building to ensure the safety of all students. Pedestrians have the right of way in a crosswalk. All parents and students are expected to exit campus through the Board of Education driveway and must turn right onto Mill Road. Students must exit in single file order. Crossing the yellow line or doubling up is not permitted.
12. Neither Brecksville-Broadview Heights High School nor Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District will be responsible for any damage or loss incurred while student vehicles are parked in the student parking lots. Lock your vehicle.
13. Violations of these rules and regulations could result in being ticketed, loss of permit, or be towed from campus.

Student Privilege and Open Campus (Pg. 20-21):

- **Remove:** Language stating that students will receive a student privilege card. These cards are no longer used because educational assistants have the ability to identify students via School Pass, ProgressBook, and a live spreadsheet that includes whether or not a student has Open Campus Privilege.
- **Add:** Language that contains the specific requirements for Open Campus as well as reasons why Open Campus may be revoked. A specific addition is included that Open Campus can be revoked if a student has 3 or more lates/tardies on arrival / return from Open Campus in a given quarter. This addition will allow for even stricter guidelines on students who have the privilege of Open Campus.

Student Privilege and Open Campus

Students may ~~apply~~ complete an application for student privileges through the Assistant Principal's Office at the start of each semester. Students who demonstrate responsible behavior, maintain good academic standing, and have acceptable attendance will earn privileges. ~~A privilege card will be issued to students that qualify. The privilege card must be presented for late arrival, early dismissal, open campus during lunch study hall, or to enter the Senior Area (room 141).~~ These privileges will be

accessible for students in grades 10, 11, or 12 that have exhibited responsible behaviors and are in good academic standing. Applications will be reviewed at the beginning of each quarter. Privileges will be revoked at any time for violating the student code of conduct and for attendance or academic concerns. The following qualifications must be met for Open Campus privileges to be awarded:

- Students must be in grades 10-12
 - (Students in grade 10 may only have Late Arrival or Early Release)
- GPA above a 2.5 during the preceding quarter;
- Passed all courses during the preceding quarter;
- Fewer than 10 total tardies (excused and unexcused) to school during the preceding quarter;
- Completed all sections in Final Forms & signed off on the student handbook. (Eligibility will be reviewed quarterly)
- **NO Schedule changes will be made to accommodate Open Campus.**
- **Final administrative approval for student privilege must be received before leaving campus. If a student leaves campus without receiving confirmation of their student privilege approval, they will have a day added to their time waiting for approval for each day taken without permission.**

Open Campus Privileges may be **revoked** at any time for any of the following reasons:

- Attendance Problems;
- 3 or more **lates/tardies** on arrival/return from Open Campus within a quarter;
- Disciplinary Referral;
- Parking Issues;
- Failure to maintain good academic standing;
- Failure to comply with the expectations of the Student Privilege Program.

Lockers (Pg. 21):

- **Update:** Language to reflect that lockers are only assigned based off of requests submitted via a Google Form sent out to all students at the beginning of the year. The form is linked in and has been used in response to students not wanting to use lockers.

Lockers

Each student ~~is assigned~~ may request a hallway locker from the assistant principal's office by completing the locker request form shared with them prior to the start of the school year. Students are to use only the locker that has been assigned to them and only the built-in combination lock—**DO NOT SHARE!** Lockers should be kept clean at all times. Leave non-essential valuables at home. Report damaged lockers to the assistant principals' office. Lockers are school property and are under the jurisdiction of school personnel. They are NOT the personal or private property of any individual and carry no expectation of privacy for the students who occupy them.

1. The school is not responsible for any missing property.
2. The administration reserves the right to inspect any locker.

Harassment (Pg. 23):

- **Remove:** Language regarding harassment on this page as it matches board policy language that appears later in the document. This language is a duplicate.

~~Harassment- (Removed because it is repeated later in document)~~

~~Harassment of any form - physical, verbal, or sexual - is viewed as a form of discrimination, will not be tolerated and will result in disciplinary action. The Brecksville-Broadview Heights Board of Education has adopted policies on discrimination and sexual harassment as found in the latter part of this handbook.~~

Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District Student Code of Conduct (Pg. 24-31):

- **Add:** Specific Language advised to be added by district legal counsel in reference to where and when the code of conduct applies as well as how Suspensions and Expulsions are to work.

- **Remove:** Language that referenced extending suspensions into the following school year if there was less than the allotted school days remaining. This language is not in state educational legal compliance any longer. All numbers were also removed from Code of Conduct Violations to prevent duplicate code violations being named in a due process hearing. Doing this may negate any potential opportunity for suspensions to be appealed and overturned on the basis of inappropriate Code of Conduct number references in the due process hearings.

BRECKSVILLE-BROADVIEW HEIGHTS CITY SCHOOL DISTRICT STUDENT CODE OF CONDUCT

This Code shall serve as a guide to all Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District students. Violation by a student of any one or more of the rules of the Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action which may include one or more of the following: warning, verbal reprimand, parental contact, working lunch, detention, Saturday school detention, community service, in-school suspension, referral to legal authorities, emergency removal, suspension, and/or expulsion.

The items in this Code apply to all students when under the authority of school personnel; on school-owned vehicles, during a school activity; whether on property-owned, rented, or maintained by another party. The Cuyahoga Valley Career Center is an extension of our school program; therefore, students who elect to attend the career center are subject to disciplinary action based upon the Student Code of Conduct of either Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District and/or the Cuyahoga Valley Career Center. Consequently, conduct and/or involvement in any activity that may or does result in disciplinary action by one school may be grounds for disciplinary action by the other school. The items in this Code also apply to misconduct, regardless of where it occurs, that is directed against a District employee or official, or the property of such employee or official. The items in this Code also apply to misconduct, regardless of where it occurs, that is directed against a District student, employee or official, or the property of such student, employee or official, or otherwise causes a substantial disruption with school activities or the overall educational mission of the District.

In the event that a student commits an offense that warrants expulsion, the Superintendent may initiate expulsion proceedings against the student even if the student withdraws from school before the Superintendent has held the hearings or made the decision to expel the student.

Suspension

Pursuant to Section 3313.66 of the Ohio Revised Code, the Superintendent, Principal or Assistant Principal may suspend a pupil from school for not more than ten (10) school days. A student suspension shall not extend beyond the current school year, if at the time the suspension is imposed, fewer than ten (10) days remain in the school year. The Superintendent may instead require a student to participate in a community service program or other alternative consequences for a number of hours equal to the remaining part of the period of the suspension. If the Superintendent elects to do so, the student shall be required to begin such community service program or alternative consequence during the first full week day of summer break. If, at the time a suspension is imposed, there are fewer than ten (10) school days remaining in the school year, in which the incident which gives rise to the suspension takes place, the Superintendent or his/her designee may apply any remaining part or all of the period of the suspension to the following year.

During an out-of-school suspension, a student is not permitted on school property and may not attend any school sponsored activities. Students with repeat suspensions forego the opportunity to receive credit for work missed. Students serving a suspension shall be permitted to complete any classroom assignments missed because of the suspension for at least partial credit. If school is closed during this time, the suspension will occur on the next day school is in session.

Suspension may be imposed for violations of the rules and regulations appearing in the Code of Conduct and Board of Education policies on student behavior. However, conduct that is prohibited both as suspension and expulsion violation may subject the student to the greater penalty of expulsion depending on the nature and severity of the student's conduct. In all cases, the decision of which penalty to assess is left to the sole discretion of the appropriate District administrator.

Misconduct for which Suspension may be Imposed

Tobacco/Vaping: The use or possession of tobacco/vaping products, accessories for E-Cigarettes or similar type of paraphernalia in a school building, on or near a school campus, or at any sanctioned school activity on or off of the campus is prohibited. Violation of the rule will be shared with local authorities which may result in a fine.

Gambling: Students shall not participate in games of chance for money or other stakes, bookmaking, wagering, or any other form of gambling.

Honor Violations: Students shall not be involved in activities including, but not limited to: cheating, plagiarism, improper collusion, misuse of privileges, forgery, or falsification of information.

Trespassing: Students shall not enter upon school grounds or premises of a school building to which the student is not assigned, except with the express permission of the school principal of that building. Students may attend or participate in a Brecksville Broadview Heights City School District sponsored events. Students are not permitted to enter upon the grounds or premises of any Board of Education facility when the student has been placed on suspension, expulsion or removal without the express permission of the building principal. Students are not permitted in the school building at such times as the building is closed.

Misuse of Facilities and Equipment: Students shall not use school facilities and/or equipment for uses other than those which were intended. Students shall not damage, destroy or deface school property, or private property on school premises.

Disruption of School: Students shall not use violence, force, noise, coercion, threat, harassment, intimidation, fear, passive resistance, or any other conduct, cause, attempt, or threaten to cause the disruption or obstruction of any mission, process, activity, or function of the school.

Use of Flame Producing Devices: The unauthorized use or possession of matches, lighters, or any other flame producing device on school property is prohibited.

Use of Profane, Indecent, or Obscene Language: Use of language of this type, whether written or verbal, directed toward or used in the presence of school personnel or students is prohibited. This shall include the use of obscene gestures, pictures and signs.

Failure to Complete Minor Disciplinary Sanction: A student who fails to complete an assigned minor disciplinary sanction such as Saturday school, in-school suspension, detention or working lunch will be subject to suspension.

Insubordination or Disrespect: Students who refuse to comply with the directions of school personnel or who talk back to, argue with, or make disrespectful comments toward any staff member or about a staff member will be subject to suspension.

Truancy: A student who misses school, including a study hall, class, lunch or any other assigned activity for part or all of a day without school authorization or who leaves the school building without administrative permission is subject to suspension.

Transmission of Prescription or Non-Prescription Medication: No student shall transmit or attempt to transmit any form of prescription or non-prescription medication to another student.

Fireworks, Smoke Bombs, or Other Similar Devices: No student shall possess, use or threaten to use fireworks, smoke bombs, or any other similar devices while on school property or while participating in any school sponsored activity.

Theft or Unauthorized Possession: Theft or unauthorized possession of school property or equipment, personal property of any District employee or of another student or visitor is grounds for suspension.

Fighting: Fighting among two or more students is grounds for suspension.

Harassment & Dating Violence: Students shall not engage in any obscene, abusive, profane or degrading gestures or expressions; racial, ethnic or religious prejudicial or disrespectful actions; harassment of any kind (including sexual) to any individual or group; intentional act of violence within a dating relationship; or intimidation (including bullying) and/or threats to an individual or group. This includes publication or distribution of materials meeting this description.

Assault: No student shall cause, attempt or threaten to cause physical injury to any person on school property or any

school event.

Extortion: Students shall not solicit money or objects of value from other students for any reason.

Complicity: Students shall not be present or in such a position as to allow or assist another student to be in violation of any school rule. This specifically includes, but is not limited to student who serve as “look outs.”

Motor Vehicle Violations: Students shall not engage in reckless, unsafe or unauthorized operation of a motor vehicle on school grounds or at school sponsored activities.

Appearance Code: Students shall not violate school rules pertaining to appearance and dress. Students shall attend dressed in a manner which is clean, not hazardous to their safety or the safety of others and which does not detract from the educational process.

Hazing: No student shall harass, persecute or participate in any act or acts or attempt to threaten, injure, disgrace, or tend to injure, degrade or disgrace any other student.

Gang Activity: Students shall not engage in any gang activity. Any indication of gang activity by the type of dress, apparel, activities, acts, behavior or manner of grooming, displayed, reflected, or participated in by a student is prohibited.

Gross Misconduct/Repeated or Flagrant Violations: Gross misconduct or repeated or flagrant violations of any school rule may result in suspension.

Violation of the Cuyahoga Valley Career Center's Student Code of Conduct: Any violation of the Cuyahoga Valley Career Center's Student Code of Conduct where suspension is normally considered appropriate is grounds for suspension from the Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District.

Repeated Tardiness to class or school

Other Grounds for Suspension: Commission of any of the acts which are grounds for expulsion could also result in suspension and/or any acts that constitute a violation of Local, State, or Federal Law.

Expulsion

Pursuant to Section 3313.66 of the Ohio Revised Code, the Superintendent may expel a pupil from school attendance for a period not to exceed the greater of eighty (80) school days or the number of school days remaining in the semester or term in which the instant it gives rise to the expulsion takes place. If at the time an expulsion is imposed there are fewer than eighty (80) school days remaining in the school year in which the incident that gives rise to the expulsion takes place, the superintendent or his/her designee may apply any remaining part or all of the period of the expulsion to the following year. Specific offenses involving firearms and knives capable of causing serious bodily injury shall result in the student's expulsion for one (1) year. The term of that expulsion may be reduced to less than one (1) year by the Superintendent for the reasons listed in Board policy. Specific offenses involving violent conduct may result in the student's expulsion for a period of up to one (1) year at the discretion of the Superintendent. Bomb threats may result in the student's expulsion for a period of up to one (1) year at the discretion of the Superintendent.

Any act that would be a criminal offense when committed by an adult that results in serious physical harm to persons or property (as defined by Section 2901.01 of the Ohio Revised Code) may subject the offender to expulsion for up to one year. Additionally, violations of the weapons in school policy may result in expulsion of up to one (1) year. The Superintendent or his/her designee may reduce the one (1) year expulsion on a case by case basis for reasons relating to the age of the student, previous offenses, the student's disability, or for individual circumstances. This list is not all inclusive.

Misconduct for which Expulsion may be Imposed

Assault: To cause or attempt to threaten or cause physical injury to any person is grounds for expulsion.

Making False Fire Alarms and Bomb Threats: Students shall not, through written, electronic or verbal means disrupt or threaten to disrupt the educational process and/or endanger or threaten to endanger the safety of school occupants by

means of false alarms and/or bomb threats.

Involvement with Alcoholic Beverages: A student shall not possess, transmit, buy, sell, conceal, use or be under the influence of any alcoholic beverage at any time the student is subject to the authority of the school. Use of an alcoholic beverage shall be determined by the professional staff and may include, but not be limited to, detection on the breath of the student, regardless of where the alcoholic beverage may have been consumed. A student shall not consume any alcoholic beverage before arrival at school or a school sponsored or related event or activity.

Involvement with Drugs and Drug Paraphernalia: A student shall not possess, use, transmit, buy, sell or conceal any of the drugs defined as a “drug of abuse” in Ohio Revised Code Section 3719.011 or possess, use, transmit, buy, sell, or conceal any of the drugs defined as “counterfeit controlled substance” in Ohio Revised Code Section 2925.01 or be under the influence of any such drugs. Nor shall any student possess, use, transmit, buy, sell or conceal any drug related paraphernalia at any time the student is subject to the authority of the school. Examples of drugs of abuse include, but are not limited to, narcotic drugs, “look alike” drugs, hallucinogenic drugs, amphetamines, barbiturates, marijuana, cocaine, or derivatives, glue, or other substances that could modify behavior. A student shall not use any drug of abuse before arrival at school or at a school sponsored or related event or activity. Use of drugs authorized by a medical prescription from a licensed physician shall not be considered a violation of this rule. However, no student may self-administer, or possess, drugs authorized by a medical prescription from a licensed physician, except for asthma inhalers and epipens. Students in grades six through 12, self-administering of non-prescription “over-the counter” medication (aspirin, ibuprofen, cough drops, etc.) shall not be considered a violation of this policy. Students in grades kindergarten through five may not self-administer any medication, whether prescription, non-prescription, or “over the counter.” A student who demonstrates behavior seemingly related to drug usage or who exhibits symptoms or physical conditions that may be related to drug usage shall be referred by a staff member for observation and questioning by a school administrator. If the suspicion of drug usage still exists, the parents shall be informed immediately and shall be requested to come to school as soon as possible. Based on his/her professional judgment, the administrator may send the student home in the custody of his/her parents. **Counterfeit, controlled substances or “look alikes” shall be defined as:**

- a. Any drug that bears, or whose container or label bears, a trademark, trade name, or other identifying mark used without authorization of the owner or writes such trademark, trade name, or identifying mark;
- b. Any unmarked or unlabeled substance that is represented to be a controlled substance manufactured, processed or packed or distributed by a person other than the person that manufactured, processed or packed or distributed it;
- c. Any substance that is represented to be a controlled substance but is not a controlled substance or is a different controlled substance;
- d. Any substance other than a controlled substance that a reasonable person would believe to be a controlled substance because of its similarity in shape, size and color for its markings, labeling, packaging, distribution for the price for which it is sold or offered for sale.

Disruption of School: A student shall not, by use of violence, force, noise, coercion, threat, harassment, intimidation, fear, passive resistance, or any other conduct, cause, attempt or threaten to cause or urge other students to cause, attempt or threaten to cause disruption or obstruction of any lawful mission, process or function of the school.

Arson/Attempted Arson/Possession of Incendiary Device: Setting fires or the use or possession of any incendiary device is prohibited.

Involvement with Weapons or Dangerous Instruments: A student shall not use, possess, handle, transmit, sell or conceal any object that can be classified as a weapon or dangerous instrument. Weapons or dangerous instruments include, but are not limited to guns, knives, metal knuckles, straight razors, explosives, noxious irritants, poisons and other dangerous substances along with any item that is a “look alike” of the above, i.e., toy guns, knives, etc. or any object which is used or may be used to inflict physical harm. Weapons violations may result in expulsion for up to one (1) year.

Harassment & Dating Violence: Students shall not engage in any obscene, abusive, profane or degrading gestures or expressions; racial, ethnic or religious prejudicial or disrespectful actions; harassment of any kind (including sexual) to any individual or group; intentional act of violence within a dating relationship; or intimidation (including bullying) and/or threats to an individual or group. This includes publication or distribution of materials meeting this description.

Violation of the Tobacco/Vape Policy: A student who violates the tobacco/vape policy for the third time is subject to

expulsion.

Repeated or Continued Violation of Minor School Conduct Rules or Rules for which Suspension may be imposed: If, after out-of-school suspension, a student continues to violate minor school conduct rules, expulsion may result at the next step. Additionally, a student who has been suspended may be expelled for new suspend able conduct after having served an out-of-school suspension.

Violation of the Cuyahoga Valley Career Center Student Code of Conduct: Violation of the Cuyahoga Valley Career Center Student Code of Conduct by committing an offense for expulsion is normally considered appropriate grounds for expulsion from the Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District.

Violation of Local, State or Federal Laws: Any act that would be a criminal offense when committed by an adult that results in serious physical harm to persons or property (as defined by Section 2901.01 of the Ohio Revised Code) is prohibited and may subject the offender to expulsion for up to one (1) year. Violation of criminal laws will also result in referral from criminal prosecution to juvenile court.

Discrimination / Harassment (Pg. 32):

- **Remove:** Language that asks those interested in filing a report to contact the HR director.
- **Add:** Language that changes the title of Director of Pupil Services to Title IX Coordinator.

DISCRIMINATION/HARASSMENT:

The Board views harassment as a form of discrimination. Harassment is defined as intimidation by threats of or actual physical violence; the creation, by whatever means, of a climate of hostility or intimidation; or the use of language, conduct or symbols in such a manner as to be commonly understood to convey hatred, contempt or prejudice or to have the effect of insulting or stigmatizing an individual.

1. Employees or students who engage in discrimination/harassment of another employee or student shall be subject to disciplinary action. Permission, consent or assumption of risk by an individual subjected to discrimination/harassment does not lessen the prohibition contained in this policy.

The Board's policy of nondiscrimination will extend to students, staff, job applicants, the general public and individuals with whom it does business and will apply to race, color or national origin, citizenship status, religion, sex, economic status, age, handicap and other human differences. To file a report contact:

Director of Human Resources

440-740-4000

6638 Mill Road, Brecksville, OH 44141

Title IX Coordinator

440-740-4000

6638 Mill Road, Brecksville, OH 44141

Tobacco/Alcohol/Drug Policy for Extracurriculars (Pg. 35-36):

- **Update:** Language has been removed and added to update the policy. The policy was initially established not to be punitive in nature but rather corrective with an educational response. This new language allows the policy to better meet this goal. The addition of the language will also deweaponize the policy and prevent students or adults from trying to use the policy to get others in trouble with the hopes of the administrative team enacting a denial of privileges. The policy changes call for students to fully enroll in a corrective program and seek help rather than denying them privileges immediately on their first offense. There is also a change that seeks to enact only a 20% denial of privileges on the second offense if the student agrees to enroll into a professional assessment program at cost to the parent, while also agreeing to complete a community service program outlined by administrations and coaches. Failure to agree or complete the program will result in a loss of 50% of the student's season.

- **Remove:** Language referencing that students are allowed one (1) voluntary referral during high school participation. This is now counter intuitive to the updated policy and goes against the goal of the program which is to get the student help.

TOBACCO/ALCOHOL/DRUG POLICY FOR EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES AND INTERSCHOLASTIC ATHLETES

STATEMENT OF PHILOSOPHY:

The Board of Education, administrators, athletic department and activity advisors of the Brecksville-Broadview Heights City Schools consider participation in extracurricular activities and interscholastic athletics to be a privilege, not a right. Students are VOLUNTEERING to participate in these programs and are expected to accept the responsibilities granted them by this privilege.

As representatives of our school district, students involved in extracurricular activities and interscholastic athletics are scrutinized by the public, become role models for young children and peers, and are ambassadors to our community. In choosing to accept this role, participants also choose the responsibilities of living a tobacco, alcohol and drug free lifestyle. Although this policy outlines the expectations and consequences required of students choosing to participate in extracurricular activities and interscholastic athletics, the parent(s) or guardian(s) retain the ultimate responsibility of promoting healthy lifestyle choices for their children and are encouraged to work cooperatively with school officials to support these ideals throughout the child's entire educational experience in the Brecksville-Broadview Heights Schools.

In keeping with the philosophy of education, the Board of Education, administrators, athletic department, and activity advisors of Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District view tobacco, alcohol, and drug use not only as a violation of the law, but as a problematic behavior which has an adverse effect on individuals and the programs in which they are involved. It is the intent, therefore, to support a disciplinary program which encourages students to recognize and deal with the causes for their use through contact with the appropriate agency (C.A.P.A., private counselors, treatment facilities, etc.) rather than being strictly punitive in nature.

This policy will be in effect during the entire calendar year, inclusive of all training, conditioning, practices, or other school related/sponsored activities, and the policy remains in effect 24 hours a day, 7 days a week (24/7—365 days).

TOBACCO AND TOBACCO PRODUCTS, ALCOHOL AND DRUGS:

Possession and/or Use of Tobacco and Tobacco Products, Alcohol or Drugs:

In accordance with the rules of Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District, except for supervised medications prescribed by a physician, a student under the influence, using, possessing, buying or receiving drugs (narcotics, hallucinogens, intoxicants, counterfeits, look-alikes, designers,) anabolic steroids, controlled substances and alcohol at any time and at any place is in violation of the code and, if apprehended by school or appropriate law enforcement personnel, is subject to the following consequences:

First Violation:

The first-time offender will be denied participation in all extracurricular and/or athletic programs for one full calendar year from the date of violation. If the student agrees to schedule himself/herself into and complete the first available school Insight Program, the denial of participation will be dropped and the student will be able to continue to participate with their extracurricular activity without a denial of participation. term of denial will be up to 20% of the activity time for extracurriculars up to 20% of scheduled competition time for athletes in any sport in which the students participate. Upon completion of the program, the student must be willing to follow the recommendations provided to continue participating in their activity. If no school Insight Program is presently available, the student's parents may choose, at their own expense, to enroll the student in an outside school-approved program. Counseling through the Insights Program (or other approved source) will take place from the date of the incident to the conclusion of the participants season and/or a minimum of five weeks within the approved intervention based program. Completion of the program is mandatory. For If a student who is involved in extracurricular activities fails to complete or actively participate in the program, the denial of participation will be enacted by school administrators with notice provided to the student and parent. up to 20% of the activity time is imposed from the time the advisor has notified the student of probation. If the offense occurs late in the school year, the denial to participate the enrollment and completion of the Insights Program or approved program may if necessary be carried over into the next school year's extracurricular participation. The term of denied participation is determined by the building administrator and extracurricular advisor.

For athletes, a full season is defined as including all the contests scheduled for a specific sport. Should the offense occur in mid-season, the denial to participate may, if necessary, be carried over into the next seasonal sport that the athlete wishes to participate in. The number of contests to be missed will be determined by the athletic director, building administrator and athlete's coach.

Second Violation:

A second offense during the student's high school career will result in denial of participation in all extracurricular and/or athletic programs **for up to 50% of the student's season.** ~~one full calendar year from the date of violation.~~ The second-time offender may reduce that denial to participate to **20% of their season** ~~one half of the school year for extracurriculars or to one full season for athletes~~ after completing a professional assessment and complying with the recommendations made by the assessing agency **as well as completing a community service program approved by the building administration.** The assessing agency must be chosen by agreement between the parents of the student and the school administration with assistance from the CAPA Coordinator.

Violations Beyond a Second Offense:

Additional violations of the alcohol/drug policy past the stipulated number of incidents will result in permanent denial to participate in any extracurricular and/or athletic programs until the offender has successfully completed a treatment program which is acceptable to the building administration and the CAPA Coordinator.

The student shall be denied participation for a minimum of one calendar year from the date of violation and must apply for reinstatement in the extracurricular and/or athletic program after completing the treatment program.

Sale and/or Distribution:

Students in violation of selling or distributing alcohol and/or drugs will be dealt with according to the Code of Student Conduct and shall be denied future participation in any extracurricular or athletic program.

Self-Referral by Students:

Students may take advantage of a self-referral procedure to seek information, guidance, counseling and/or assessment in regard to his/her use of alcohol and/or drugs. First time voluntary referrals DO NOT carry any punitive consequences.

- ~~1. Students are allowed one (1) voluntary referral during their high school participation.~~
2. Self-referrals can be made by the student or by his/her immediate family.
3. Self-referral cannot be used as a method to avoid consequences once a rule of the Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District's extracurricular and interscholastic athletic policy is violated and a student has been identified as having violated that rule.
4. Students must make self-referrals to an advisor, coach, athletic director, teacher, administrator, counselor, or the district C.A.P.A. Coordinator.
5. Self-referrals will lead to placement and completion in the schools' Insight Program and/or referral to an approved assessing agency.
6. Those referrals to an assessing agency will remain confidential; however, proper release of information forms must be on file with the designated trained chemical dependency personnel.